

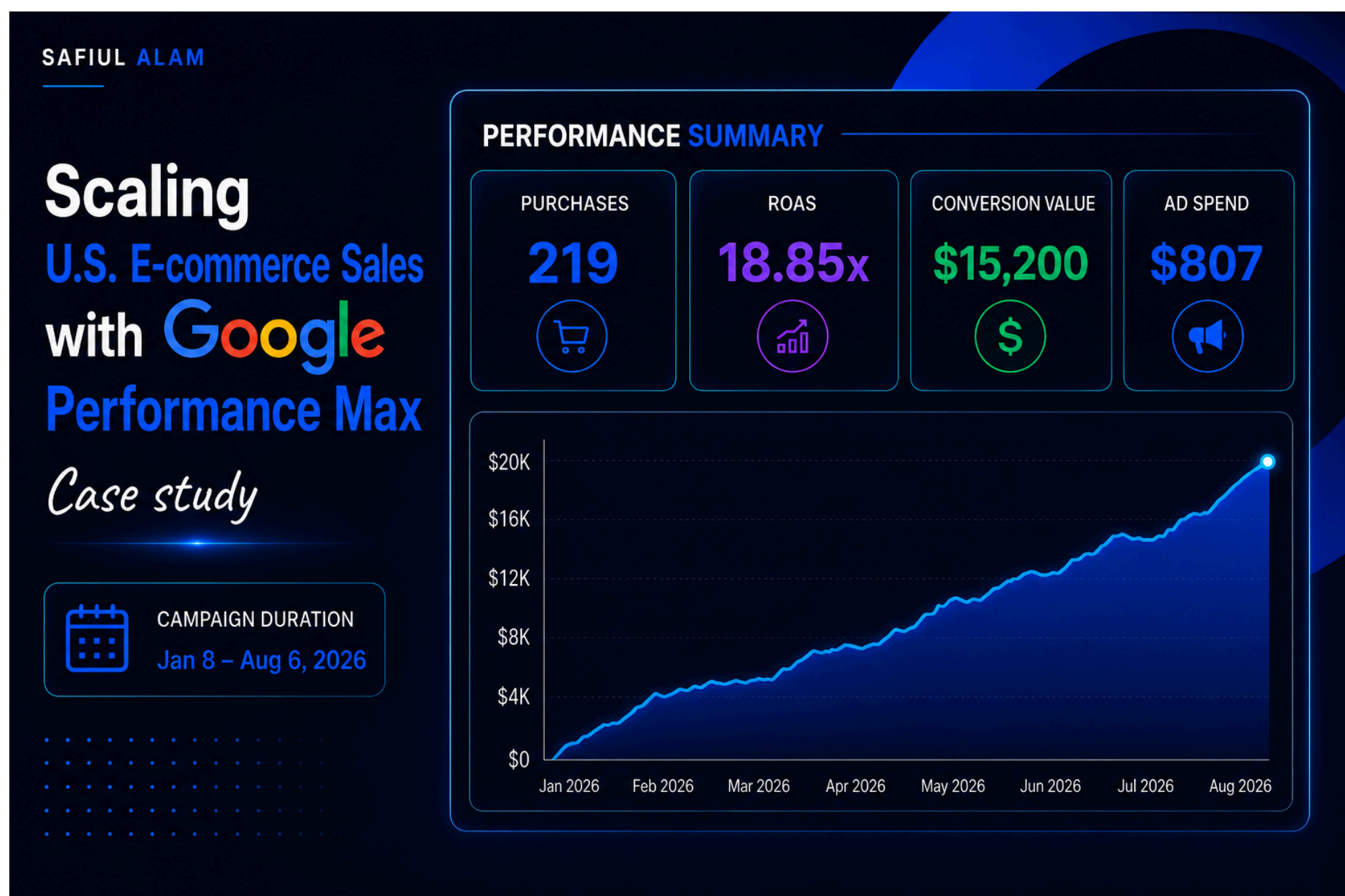
Google Ads Case Study: Driving 18.85× ROAS for a U.S. Running Shoes Brand

\$807 Ad Spend → \$15,200 Tracked Conversion Value → 219 Purchases

Industry: E-commerce / Running Shoes

Market: United States

Campaign: Performance Max



The Situation

When I first took over the account, the business was already running Google Ads and getting purchases.

So the problem wasn't that the account wasn't generating sales. The bigger question was whether the budget was being used in the right way.

After going through the existing campaigns and their performance, one issue stood out: the bidding approach wasn't properly aligned with the goal of generating purchase value.

There was also an opportunity to improve how the budget was distributed across products. Some products were getting spend without producing enough return, while stronger opportunities weren't getting the attention they deserved.

I didn't want to solve that by simply increasing the budget.

My first priority was to make the existing spend more efficient.

What I Found in the Account

I started by looking at the account from a business perspective rather than just looking at campaign-level metrics.

I wanted to know:

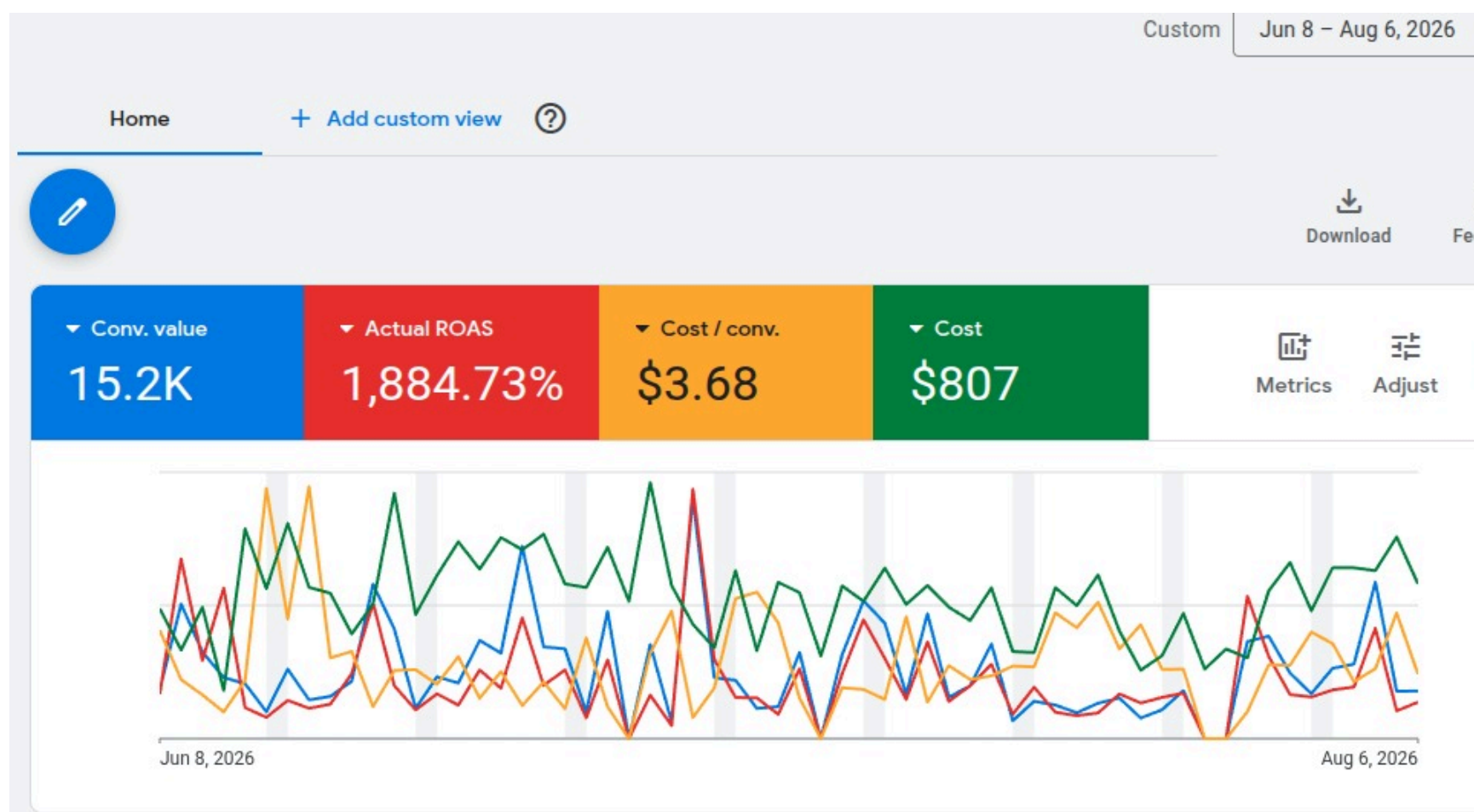
- Which products were actually generating sales?
- Where was the budget going?
- Which products were spending without producing enough value?
- What types of searches were bringing potential buyers?
- Where were customers showing interest but not completing the purchase?

The biggest change I identified was the bidding strategy.

The campaign needed to be more closely aligned with purchase value, so I shifted the strategy toward conversion-value optimization.

At the same time, I reviewed product performance to understand where the budget had the strongest potential.

That gave me a much clearer starting point for rebuilding the campaign.



The Strategy I Built

I kept the strategy fairly simple.

Instead of trying to solve everything at once, I focused on three things:

Better bidding direction.

Better product focus.

Better decisions from performance data.

For bidding, I moved the campaign toward conversion value rather than treating clicks as the primary measure of success.

For products, I looked at actual sales and conversion value to identify the products worth giving more attention.

And for customer intent, I researched what people were actually searching for before deciding how the campaign should be organized and how the products should be presented.

For example, searches around marathon running, trail running, lightweight shoes, cushioning and running shoe deals tell us very different things about what a shopper is looking for.

That information influenced the campaign's product focus, messaging and search themes.

Creative Direction

I also gave the client recommendations for the creative assets that would support the campaign.

I wasn't looking for complicated advertising concepts. For an e-commerce running shoe brand, the product needs to be clear first.

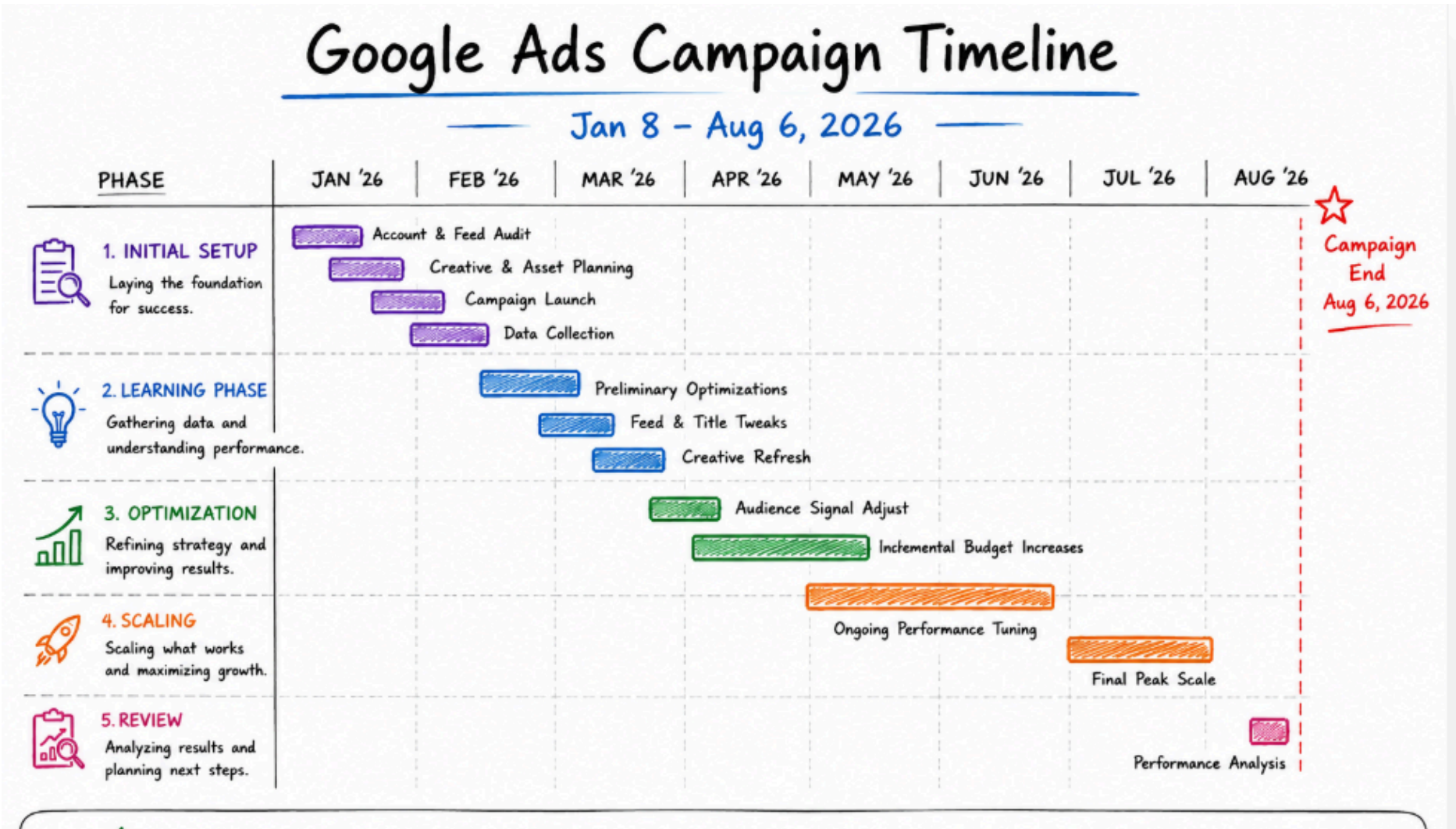
I recommended a combination of:

- Clean product images showing the shoes clearly
- Lifestyle images showing the shoes being used
- Short product videos
- Customer reviews and ratings
- Promotional messaging where appropriate

I also suggested different messaging angles depending on what the customer cared about.

For example, one customer might be looking for maximum cushioning for long-distance running, while another may care more about lightweight performance or trail durability.

The creative direction was built around those differences rather than showing everyone the exact same message.



Campaign Setup

I rebuilt the campaign using Performance Max, with the main focus on online purchases and conversion value.

The campaign was organized around product and customer needs rather than treating every product as equally important.

The main directions included:

Cushioning / Comfort

Focused on long-distance running and comfort.

Trail Running

Focused on grip, durability and outdoor performance.

Performance / Marathon

Focused on lightweight design, speed and training.

Promotional

Focused on offers and purchase incentives when relevant.

I also used relevant customer and website data, together with search-intent research, to give Google clearer signals about the types of shoppers and searches that mattered to the business.

What Happened After Launch

This is where the real work started.

I didn't want to make decisions based on a single day's results, so I watched how spending, purchases, product performance and conversion value developed over time.

One of the main things I looked at was the relationship between spend and actual sales value.

If a product was taking spend but wasn't producing enough sales, I didn't keep giving it the same level of attention just because it was receiving clicks.

On the other hand, when I saw products consistently generating purchases and stronger conversion value, I looked for opportunities to give those products more focus.

I also looked at the wider customer journey.

If people were clicking but not moving further toward a purchase, that was a signal to investigate rather than simply spend more.

My decision process was simple:

Look at the data → understand what is happening → make one focused change → measure the result.

How I Managed the Budget

I was careful about scaling.

A campaign showing good ROAS doesn't automatically mean you should immediately double the budget.

I wanted to see that the performance was reasonably stable first.

Once the campaign showed consistent purchase activity and healthy efficiency, I increased the budget gradually and watched what happened next.

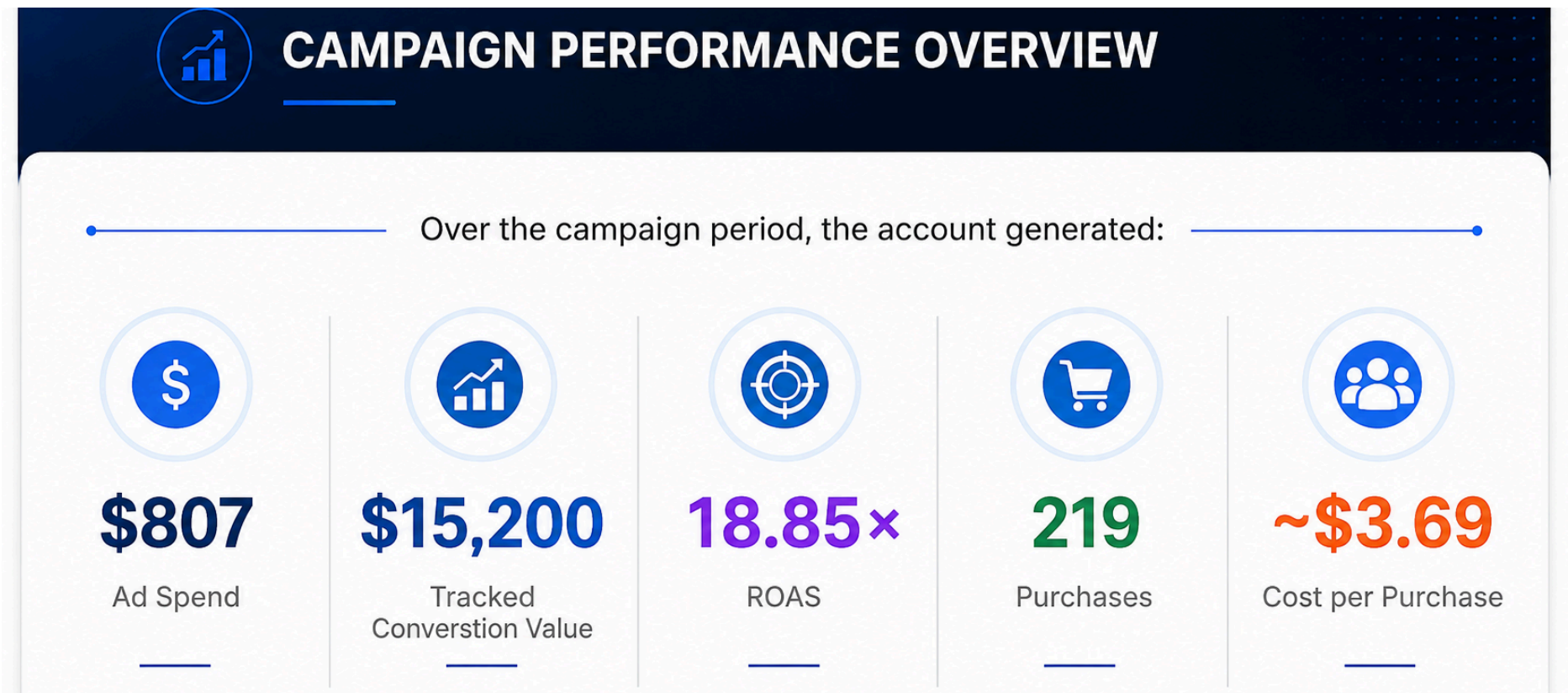
If the numbers remained healthy, I continued.

If efficiency weakened, I focused on optimization before pushing the budget further.

For me, the rule was:

Prove the campaign can use the money efficiently before giving it more money.

The Results



The campaign generated approximately \$18.85 in tracked conversion value for every \$1 spent.

More importantly, the campaign gave the business a clearer process for deciding where to spend, what to prioritize and when to scale.

What Made the Difference

Looking back, I don't think the result came from one particular Google Ads trick.

The improvement came from getting several things working together:

The right bidding direction

→ Stronger product focus

→ Better understanding of customer intent

→ Relevant creative recommendations

→ Consistent performance analysis

→ Controlled budget decisions

The biggest lesson from this campaign was simple:

Don't increase the budget just because a campaign is getting sales. First understand where the sales are coming from and whether the campaign can use additional budget efficiently.

My Role

I handled the campaign from the initial account review through strategy, campaign setup, creative recommendations, performance analysis, optimization and budget management.

My focus throughout the campaign was not simply to generate more clicks.

It was to make better decisions with the advertising budget and improve the efficiency of the sales generated from it.

Business Impact

The campaign helped the business generate \$15,200 in tracked conversion value from just \$807 in ad spend, while driving 219 purchases at an 18.85× ROAS. Beyond the immediate sales, the campaign gave the business a more efficient and data-driven way to allocate its advertising budget, prioritize stronger products, and make more confident decisions about future investment.